

STELLAR LEVEL 5 SUBMISSION

BountyFlow

Work gets done. Rewards move transparently.

Bounty rewards are held in a Soroban escrow contract on Stellar and paid out on-chain.

BUILT AND MAINTAINED BY

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Stellar Testnet • Escrow contract CDX6FN2M...4SFY4CY

Problem and solution

WHAT IS BROKEN

- Contributors deliver the work, then **wait or chase** for money they were promised.
- Requesters pay up front and **hope** the result matches the brief.
- "Funded" on most platforms is **a label in a database**, not money anyone can verify.
- Cross-border payouts lose **3–7% to fees** and take days to clear.
- Disputes are settled by the platform, behind closed doors, with no shared record.

THE NEED

A marketplace where the reward is locked before work starts, and every movement of money can be checked by both sides.

WHAT BOUNTYFLOW DOES

Each bounty's reward goes into a Soroban escrow **before anyone starts work**. Delivery is tracked through an explicit state machine, and only verified on-chain events move money-related state.



Funded means funded

A bounty reads Funded only when the contract confirms it holds the reward.



Paid means paid

A payment reads Confirmed only when the contract reports the contributor as paid.

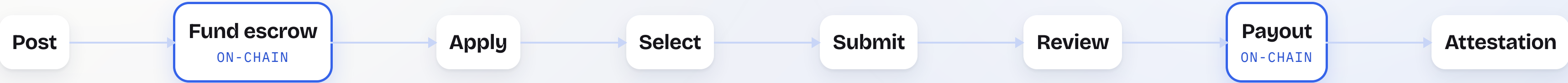


Refunds follow rules

A refund cannot bypass the contract's conditions, and there is no admin withdrawal.

How a bounty moves

Every step is an explicit state. The two that touch money are settled by the contract, not the server.

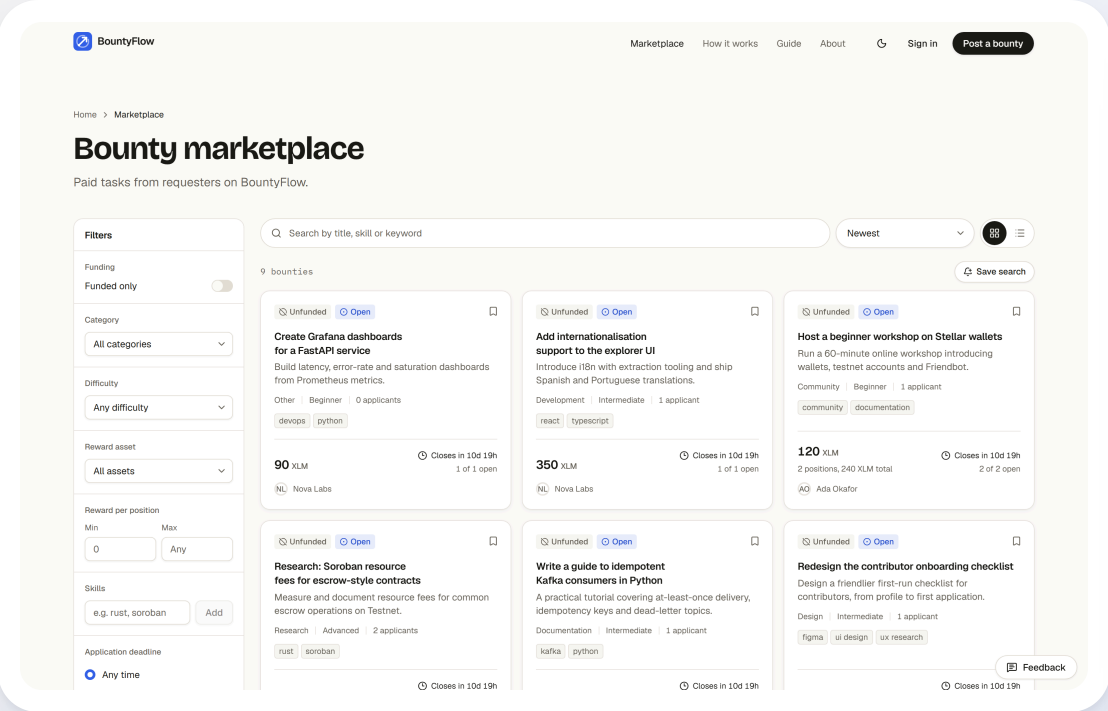


IF THE REQUESTER GOES QUIET

A contributor whose submission is recorded on-chain can claim the reward once the review window closes.

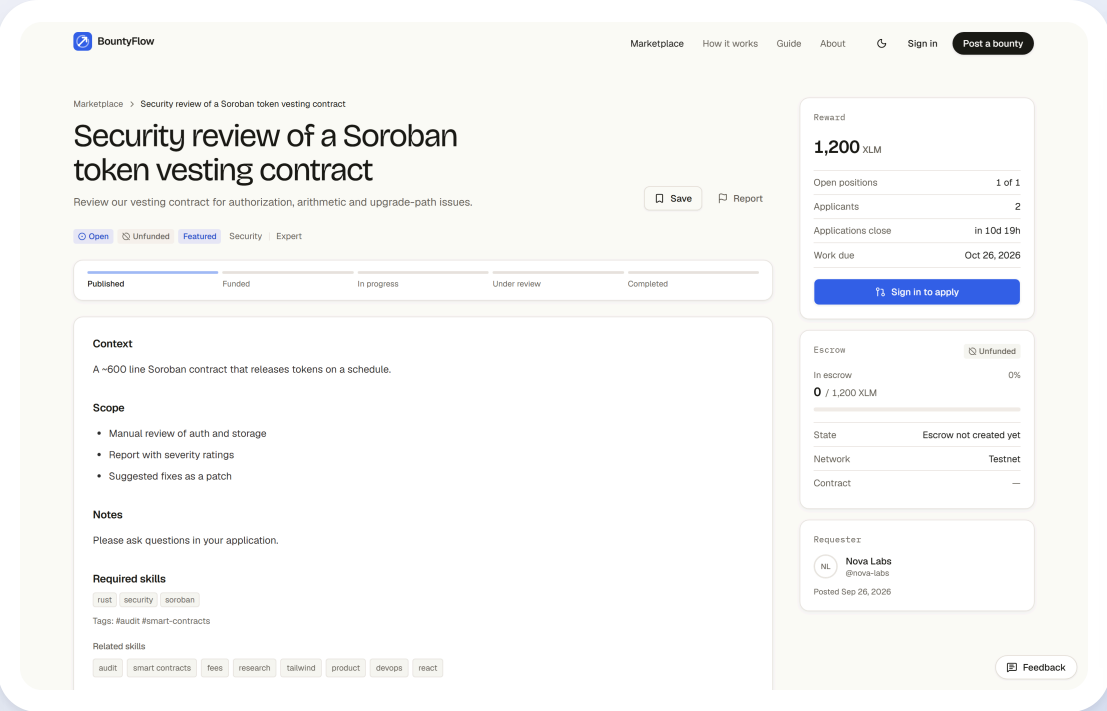
IF THE TWO SIDES DISAGREE

A dispute freezes the escrow and is decided by an M-of-N arbiter set, with split outcomes allowed.



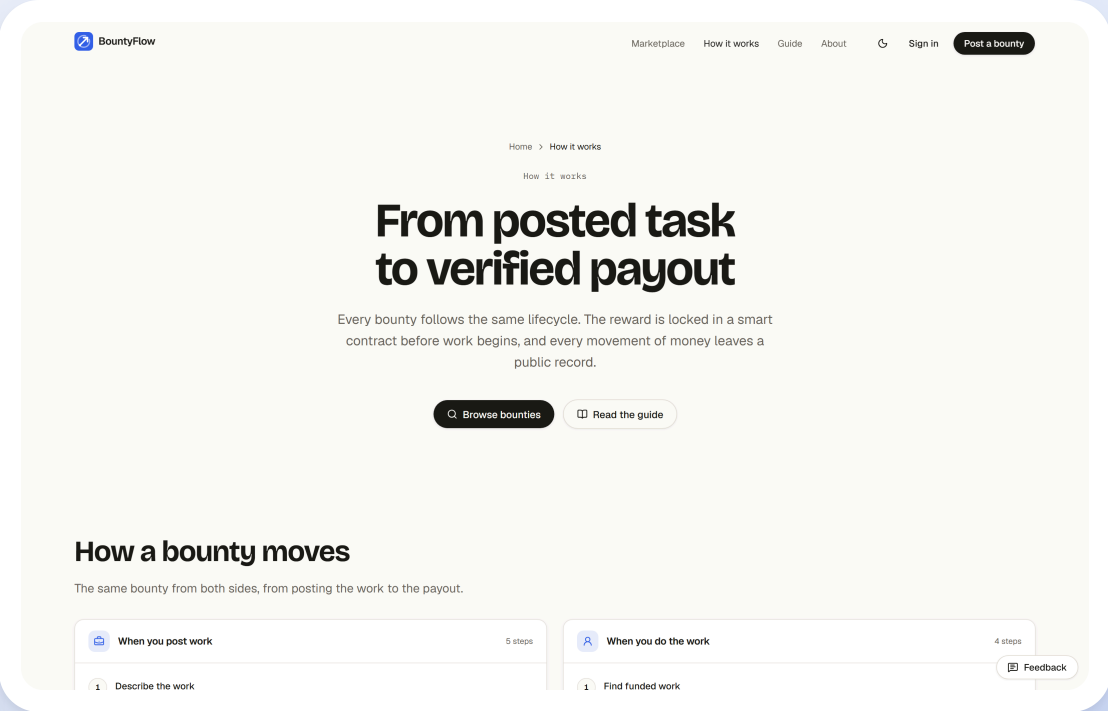
Marketplace

Search and filter by skill, reward, difficulty, deadline and funding.



Bounty detail

Escrow state, reward asset, public questions, and the linked pull request.



How it works

The escrow state machine, on the page new users land on first.

Market opportunity

The cost of paying someone for a small piece of work is mostly the cost of not trusting them.

10–20%

Typical freelance platform take rate on every job

3–7%

Lost to fees on a cross-border payout

~5s

Stellar ledger close, so a payout is near-immediate

<\$0.01

Network cost of a Soroban escrow operation

WHO THIS IS FOR

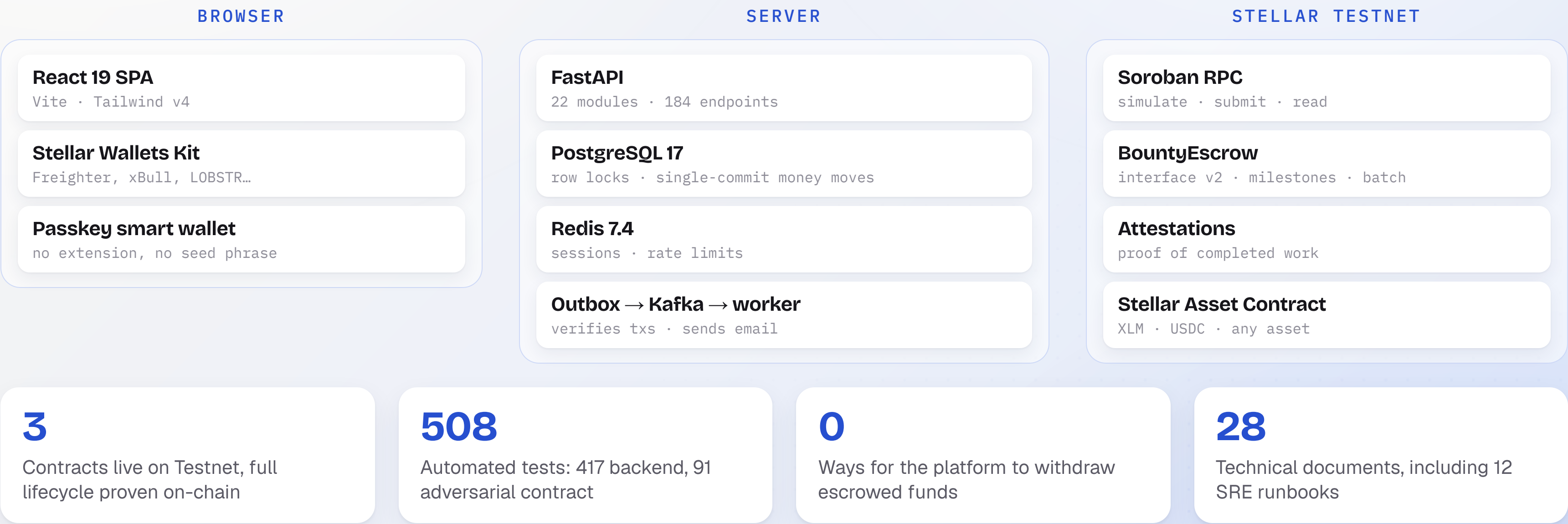
- **Open-source maintainers** paying for issues they cannot staff themselves.
- **Protocol and ecosystem teams** running grants and paid contributor programmes.
- **Contributors in any country**, who today absorb both the fee and the wait.

WHY STELLAR

- Fees low enough that a **\$20 bounty still makes sense** to post.
- **USDC and any Stellar asset** settle through that asset's contract.
- Finality fast enough that a payout feels like a button, not a transfer.

Architecture

A modular monolith with a worker beside it. Contract calls are simulated on the server, signed in the wallet, then verified before anything is recorded.



The rule that holds it together: no money-related state changes on the server's word. It changes when the chain confirms it, and the worker reconciles anything left in doubt.

Growth strategy

Contributors follow funded work. So the strategy is to make funded work exist, and make the first one easy to finish.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| Remove the first barrier | A passkey wallet and sponsored network fees mean a new contributor needs no extension, no seed phrase and no XLM to claim their first bounty. |
| Seed the supply side | Partner with open-source maintainers who already have unstaffed issues, and fund a first cohort of small, well-scoped bounties. |
| Make finished work portable | Every completed bounty becomes an on-chain attestation and a W3C verifiable credential, so a contributor's record follows them off the platform. |
| Bring the work to people | Saved searches with instant or digest alerts, and skill-graph recommendations that always show which skills matched. |
| Earn the second bounty | The review window and the dispute path mean a contributor who delivers gets paid even if the requester disappears. That is what brings them back. |

WHERE THIS STANDS TODAY

The platform and the contracts are ready and proven on Testnet. Recruiting the first cohort of 50 contributors is the open piece of work.

Future roadmap

Each item names the thing that currently blocks it.

Mainnet

Gated on an independent contract audit. The deployment guard refuses every contract id until a real audit report is recorded.

Compliance

KYC and AML decisions, name screening rather than address only, geographic controls, and tax reporting.

Wallet recovery

A recovery path for passkey wallets that does not make BountyFlow custodial. A lost passkey is unrecoverable today, by design.

Payments

Sponsoring a trustline's reserve, so a contributor holding no XLM can add one and be paid in USDC.

Escrow

An on-chain pause for emergencies. The contract is permissionless by design today, which cuts both ways.

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